WEB OF DICE

Pick 3 heroes, walk a web of places, take quests, fight with d20 duels, and bank gold at the Guild

D&D-STYLE DICE ROGUELITE · PARTY OF 3 · WEB MAP · GODOT 4.7 · MILESTONE 3b

One-line pitch

A mobile + PC roguelite where you walk a web of places (tavern, field, ruins…) from a Guild hub, make risky dice-driven choices, take optional quests, and survive to a major final battle.

Reading Key

This brief describes the game as it exists in the repo today:

- **IN BUILD** Built and tested in code (file references in footers)
- **SUGGESTED** My recommendation, not in the game yet
- **OPEN** Listed as unfinished in the project docs
- Mockups are drawn for this brief in the game's own palette (art/pal.gd); they are not screenshots



Title: PLAY · GUILD HALL · HARDCORE

Loop & map

Guild, web, danger, quests (p.2)

Battle & party

d20 duels, 12 classes, death saves (p.3–5)

Economy & balance

Gold, items, Guild upgrades, Balance v3 (p.6–7)

Where it fits & next

vs. our concepts, mobile path, next steps (p.8–10)

1. CORE LOOP & THE WEB MAP

Walk the Web. Watch the Danger. Get Home.

GUILD Quests · rest · hire › **PARTY** Pick 3 of 12 › **WALK** One step at a time › **RESOLVE** Fight · event · shop › **QUEST** Follow the gold route › **BANK** Return to the Guild › **BOSS** The Hollow King

IN BUILD The web

A seeded 30-place graph you can walk in any direction. Only neighbours are clickable. Vision starts at 1 step (max 3); farther places show as fog '?'. Every place has a unique name (Old Mill Bridge, The Gilded Boar...), and used places become plain road.

IN BUILD Danger meter

+1 per step (max 20), reset to 0 at the Guild; taverns and camps lower it. Each step rolls an ambush: 3% + 2% × danger (max 50%). From 10 danger, enemies get +15% HP and +1 damage per step.

IN BUILD Places

Guild · Fight · Elite (never within 3 steps of the Guild) · Tavern (rest, or rumours that reveal the boss) · Camp · Shop · Event (d20 choices) · Cage (pick a lock, 60%) · Ruin · Final Battle.



Map: glowing neighbours, fog, a quest route in gold, the danger bar

Web of Dice · design brief · Facts from docs/game_data.json (nodes, danger_meter, vision) and scripts/logic/graph.gd.

2. BATTLE

Every Roll Shows Its Odds



Battle: turn bar, the d20 result, odds on every button

IN BUILD ## The rule

Hit if **d20 + to-hit ≥ 10 + DEF**. Natural 20 = critical hit (damage dice doubled); natural 1 = FUMBLE (your next d20 has disadvantage). The % printed on each button is the exact chance; tests check it over 20,000 rolls.

IN BUILD ## A turn

Initiative d20 sets the order. Each hero picks **1 Attack · 2 Skill · 3 Defend · 4 Potion · 5 Flee** (55%, not allowed vs the boss), plus a 6th button for hirelings. Skills recharge on a d6 roll of 5–6.

IN BUILD ## Enemies telegraph

Each enemy glows, shows its target arrow and hit chance, then attacks. The Ogres, Troll, Bandit Captain and the boss attack twice. **The Hollow King** enrages at half HP (+1 hit, +2 damage) and summons a Bone Rattler.

SUGGESTED This is the strongest hook in the project, and it's the same one GPT picked out of Delve & Dice: **dice you can see, with honest odds**. Make the d20 roll the hero of every trailer and screenshot.

3. PARTY & CLASSES

Twelve Classes, Pick Three

Class	Role	HP	Signature skill
Barbarian	Frontline bruiser	34	Rage: +2 dmg, half damage taken
Bard	Support and buffs	20	Rousing Song: all heal 3, ally Inspired
Cleric	Healer and shield	26	Mending Light: heal 9, raises the downed
Druid	Nature caster	24	Entangling Roots 1d8+3 + weaken
Fighter	Armoured tank	30	Power Strike 2d8+3, stun
Monk	Quick striker	22	Flurry 2 × (1d6+3)
Paladin	Holy knight	28	Divine Smite +2d8
Ranger	Ranged hunter	24	Twin Arrows 2 × (1d8+3)
Rogue	Burst damage	22	Backstab: advantage, +2d6
Sorcerer	Area spells	20	Chaos Burst 2d6+1 on every foe
Warlock	Dark blaster	24	Eldritch Barrage 2 × (1d10+3), costs 3 HP
Wizard	Arcane nuker	20	Arcane Bolt 3d4+3, ignores armour



Party select: 4 × 3 cards, order badges, RANDOM PARTY

IN BUILD Each class has a hit die, main stat, armour, one signature skill, a flaw note and 2 subclass tags (subclass skills go to hirelings only). Stats derive D&D-style from six ability scores: HP = 2 × hit die + 6 + 2 × CON mod.

4. DEATH, SAVES & HIRELINGS

Heroes Fall. Some Get Back Up.



Death save: tracker dots, the d20 verdict, revives left

IN BUILD **Down, not out**

At 0 HP a hero is DOWN. On their turn they roll a death save: 10+ success, under 10 failure, natural 1 = two failures, natural 20 = back up with 1 HP. 3 successes = stable; 3 failures = **dead for good**.

IN BUILD **Revive cap**

Potions, heal skills or a rest raise a downed hero. Each hero has **3 revives per career**; going down with none left is instant death. Dead heroes take their gear with them.

IN BUILD **Hirelings**

The Guild offers 3 hires per visit: random class and subclass, stats rolled 4d6-drop-lowest, 30–100 gold. Only hires get the subclass skill (a 6th button).

SUGGESTED Death saves are the most dramatic moment in the game. Give them the full 'Loot Roll' treatment from our concept briefs: slow the roll down, then celebrate a natural 20 with flash and sound.

Gold, Potions, Charms, Gear and the Guild

IN BUILD Potions

Healing d8+6 (10g) · Greater d10+10 (20g) · Superior d20+15 (loot only). Shared stock; a potion can revive a downed hero.

IN BUILD Charms

9 stackable passives: Hare's Foot +1 init, Grave Token +2 death saves, Wolf Fang +1 dmg, Lucky Coin, Iron Nail, Merchant's Seal... Lost when the run ends.

IN BUILD Gear chain

None → Adamantine +1 → Enspelled +2 → Vorpal +3 attack. Shop 60g, or loot. Belongs to one hero; lost if that hero dies.

IN BUILD Guild upgrades

Banked gold buys permanent upgrades: Far Sight (+1 vision), Hardy Recruits (+5 HP), Guild Rations (+1 potion). HARDCORE mode turns them off.

IN BUILD Quests

Slay the Bandit Captain → Ember Blade (+2 ATK) · Deliver the sealed letter → +1 vision · Reach the old ruin → 40 gold · Hunt the Marsh Ogre → Battle Focus (skills recharge on 4–6). The route to the target lights up in gold.



Guild Hall: quests, hires, upgrades, rest

6. BALANCE v3

Tuned by Feel, Not Just Win Rate

Fight (Fighter/Cleric/Ranger)	Win	Party HP lost	Downs / fight	Rounds
normal near	100%	12%	0.01	4.0
normal deep	100%	17%	0.02	5.2
elite near	99%	27%	0.13	5.8
elite deep	94%	43%	0.54	7.7
boss (run party)	82%	55%	1.00	9.7

IN BUILD After the first playtest ("enemies two-shot every hero, Eldritch Blast did 2 damage"), heroes and enemies moved to D&D-style numbers, and a **feel report** now measures rounds, HP lost, downs, deaths, the largest hit and misses over 300 seeds per row.

Target bands (from BALANCE_SPEC.md)

- Normal: 3–5 rounds, 15–35% HP lost, almost no downs
- Elite: 4–6 rounds, 35–60% lost, ~1 down
- Boss: 7–10 rounds, 50–80% lost, 55–75% win
- No single normal hit over 40% of a full-HP hero

OPEN Bands not met yet

- Normal fights are too easy for healer parties (12% HP lost, 100% win)
- Bard/Wizard/Rogue struggles in deep elites (62% win)
- Only **10–53% of bot runs reach the Final Battle**; about 3.75 fights per rest place
- Nobody has played Balance v3 yet; it's logic and tests only

7. WHERE IT FITS

Web of Dice Already Is Our Dice Game

	Web of Dice (built)	Delve & Dice (concept)	The Last Lantern (concept)
Hook	Visible d20 with honest odds, death saves	Visible d20 boons and a Loot Roll	Extract or push
Party	3 of 12 classes, turn-based	3 (GPT: 1 + companion)	1 hero
Map	30-place web, any direction, fog, danger	Branching rooms per floor	Rooms with shrines
Combat input	You pick every action of every hero	Auto-battle	Auto-combat + dodge
Run → meta	Bank gold at the Guild	Gold → tavern	Extract at a shrine
Status	Built, milestone 3b	Concept	Concept

SUGGESTED

It's further along than any concept

Everything Delve & Dice proposed (visible dice, D&D classes, a tavern hub) exists here as working code with tests. It would be faster to build on Web of Dice than to start Delve & Dice.

SUGGESTED

It already has 'extract or push'

Walking back to the Guild to bank gold while danger climbs *is* The Last Lantern's extract-or-push decision. Make it explicit: show what's at risk on the map and reward the walk home.

SUGGESTED

The big difference: it's mid-core

You choose every action of every hero, so it's turn-based tactics, not the auto-battle of Cup Heroes and our concepts. That depth is its identity, but it means longer sessions and a smaller mobile audience.

From a PC Build to a Phone



Inventory: gold, potions by type, charms, hero panels

IN BUILD ## Already mobile-friendly

Touch input works and all hit areas are large. Art is drawn in code (no asset files), so it scales cleanly. The design doc names 'mobile + PC, start as a web build'.

OPEN ## Landscape at 1280×720

Phones are usually held upright for casual play. Landscape suits PC and tablets; a portrait battle layout would be a real redesign (heroes over enemies, a two-row action bar).

SUGGESTED ## Monetization, if any

Keep the Cup Heroes system filter: no gems, no paid random packs, no stamina. Sell a **$4.99 one-time unlock** or a premium price, plus **cosmetics** (dice skins, hero outfits). Never sell hirelings, revives or gear, because permadeath only means something if it can't be bought back.

9. NEXT STEPS

What the Project Says Is Next

OPEN From the project TODO

- Nobody has LOOKED at the 3b screens yet; check the 5 screenshot sets
- Balance v3 has never been played by a person
- Bot runs reach the boss only 10–53% of the time (too few rest places)
- Class unlocks exist but nothing locks yet
- Hire screen still the 3a version; lying pose is a rotation
- Screenshot/window tests disabled until the PC freezes are explained

SUGGESTED Before more content

- **Playtest one full run** with your partner on Balance v3
- Add 1–2 rest places, or make the Guild walk-back safer, so ~60% of runs reach the boss
- Decide on mobile orientation before building more screens
- Write down the 'one more run' reason (the Guild unlocks list)

SUGGESTED Keep out for now

- More classes (12 is already a lot)
- A wide-open world map
- Online features, guilds, PvP
- Any store work until a person has finished a run and wants another

SUGGESTED **A clear pass/fail test:** after one full run, does the tester ask to play again *and* say which class they'd try next? If yes, the 12-class roster is pulling its weight. If not, cut to 6 for the mobile version.

Legal note from the design doc: no D&D trademarks or names; build on open 5e SRD concepts with original world, creatures and names. The project already follows this (e.g. 'Arcane Bolt', 'The Hollow King').